

When the air sings of summer

from "The Old Maid and the Thief"

Gian Carlo Menotti

Andante calmo, ma senza trascinare

Bob: *mp*

When the air sings of sum - mer, I must

p legato *mp*

This system contains the first two measures of the piece. The vocal line (Bob) begins with a half rest followed by a melodic phrase. The piano accompaniment starts with a half rest, then enters with a melody in the right hand and a bass line in the left hand. The key signature has one flat (B-flat) and the time signature is 4/4.

3 wan - der a - gain. Sweet land-lord is the sky, rich house is the plain,

pochiss. riten. *a tempo*

This system contains measures 3 through 5. Measure 3 begins with a triplet of eighth notes. Measures 4 and 5 feature a tempo change from 'pochiss. riten.' to 'a tempo'. The piano accompaniment continues with a steady bass line and a more active right hand.

6 and to live is to wan - der through the sun and the rain.

poco rit. *mp*

This system contains measures 6 through 8. Measure 6 begins with a triplet of eighth notes. The system concludes with a 'poco rit.' marking. The piano accompaniment features a melodic line in the right hand and a supporting bass line in the left hand.

a tempo

When the air sings of sum-mer, I must wan-der a-gain.

mp

First you wan-der in youth and joy then you'll wan-der to still the fears

f ma dolce

in an old heart. First you wan-der to find your love,

15 *rall.*

then you'll wan - der to hide your tears, for a wand'-rer must de - part.

17 *p*

When a man owns a house he is a bird ina a cage whose cap-tiv-i - ty pain

20 *Largamente* *ff* *rit.*

is sweet - en'd with age. Ah! — the sharp joys of free - dom

23 **Andante**
pp

mf a tempo *poco allarg.*

is my loss and my gain When the air sings of sum - mer, I must

25 *a tempo* *molto rall.*

wan - der a - gain. _____

f *ff* *lunga*